

VALEN COLE

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EDUCATION

University of Utah — Salt Lake City, UT

B.A. International Studies (Trade & Commerce). Minors: Business AI, French. Expected May 2027.

Cumulative GPA 3.41. Dean's List: Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026.

Faculty-led field program: Development and Prosperity in Ghana, Summer 2026 — fieldwork with Health 2 Go.

Relevant coursework: Multinational Enterprises & International Trade; Business Strategy & AI; Programming with Python.

RESEARCH & ANALYSIS

"Compliance Without Preservation", Published Policy Analysis — Ghana Road Maintenance Financing

September 2026 | valencole.com/writing/ghana-roads

- Authored a 9,200-word policy analysis after faculty-led fieldwork, drawing on 52 sources including seven Ghanaian statutes and five peer-reviewed studies.
- Showed how contractor arrears (GH¢10.5bn, 3.4× annual fund revenue) drain a ring-fenced maintenance fund, and how four loosely drafted instruments allow full legal compliance while roads deteriorate.
- Proposed four reforms ordered by what each requires; revised the memo publicly after faculty review to engage prior literature.

France–U.S. Investment Conversion Study, Independent Research, in progress

2026

- Building a panel of U.S.-origin Choose France announcements (2018–2026) to measure how often announced commitments become deployed capital, and how much headline money is re-announced.
- Classifying each outcome with a cited source; validating the scoring on held-out 2024–25 cohorts against Banque de France data.

Conference Presentations, University of Utah

Co-presenter, "Cognitive Security," AI + Ethics Faculty Workshop (2026) — only undergraduate presenter. | Selected speaker, Student AI Symposium (2025).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Quality Control Assistant, Unlimited Design

Salt Lake City, UT | Aug 2024 – May 2025

- Ran weekly QC testing on 14+ precast concrete batches against Architectural Precast Association standards, escalating outliers before production.
- Rebuilt reporting workflows, cutting reporting time roughly in half; managed timelines for a 10-person team and client invoicing.

Community Advisor, University of Utah Housing & Residential Education

Salt Lake City, UT | Aug 2025 – Present

- Maintain FERPA-protected records and incident documentation for a 40+ resident community.
- Serve as overnight first responder for medical, security, and conduct incidents.

Data Collection Contractor (1099), Handshake — Project Lexicon

Remote | Dec 2025 – Present (project-based)

- Recorded conversation sets for voice-model training and captured indoor and outdoor spatial video to spec.

Barback, White Horse Spirits & Kitchen

Salt Lake City, UT | Aug 2026 – Present | Previously server assistant, PF Chang's (2025–26). Held alongside the Community Advisor role and up to 22 credit hours.

SKILLS

Languages: English (native); French (advanced professional proficiency).

Analysis: Excel, Python, SQL (coursework), panel dataset construction, source verification. | Technical: HTML/CSS/JS, Git.